

Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ J 10 9 7
♦ 10 5 3
♣ A K 7 5

♠ K J 7 3
♥ A 6 3
♦ K J 9 2
♣ 10 4



♠ A 9 6 5
♥ K Q 4 2
♦ A 8 7
♣ Q 8

♠ Q 10 2
♥ 8 5
♦ Q 6 4
♣ J 9 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
providing for the discard of a ♦ loser. West might hold the ♦Q so that finesse works.

Suppose you win the ♥ in your hand and try the ♠ finesse. If East has the ♠Q you will then have to find the ♥s splitting, which is not likely, or the ♦Q in the West hand.

A better plan would be to shun the trump Queen finesse entirely. Play the ♠K, then ♠A. If the ♠Q falls then pull the last trump and you are home free.

If the ♠Q DOESN'T fall, play your other two ♥ winners. When East discards on the last ♥ you exit with a small trump to a defender's ♠Q.

If West wins the ♠ you will just have to depend on the ♦ finesse. But if East takes the trick he will be endplayed, having to give you a ruff/sluff in ♣s, or lead into dummy's ♦ K J.

This plan combines several chances.

With both Majors, the correct response to Stayman is 2♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

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Partner denies having 4♥s so obviously he must hold 4♠s. You therefore correct the contract to 4♠, your known 4-4 Major fit.

South plays 4♠. West takes two top ♣s, then leads the ♥J.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 4

There are lots of possibilities for getting rid of one loser. The ♠Q might drop, or she might be in the West hand, finessable. The ♥s might split 3-3,

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 9 8 3

♥ 9 8 3

♦ K J 5

♣ 6 2

♠ J 7

♥ A Q 7 2

♦ 8 3

♣ J 10 9 7 5



♠ Q 5 2

♥ J 10 6 4

♦ Q 10 4

♣ K 8 3

♠ K 6 4

♥ K 5

♦ A 9 7 6 2

♣ A Q 4

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
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Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
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All Pass

3NT by South

♠K at the first trick.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

Not only do you need 3 more winners, you need to get them without losing the lead because the instant you lose the lead West will take all his ♠ winners. You can **HOPE** that will only be 3 of them but you can't depend on it.

The ♣ suit is your only hope. If East holds the ♣K you can finesse him out of it. However, if he has ♣ K x x and refuses to cover your ♣J, you will have to have a second entry to dummy to cash the good ♣s.

As it happens, you do have two entries, the ♥A and ♥Q! You just have to sacrifice your ♥K to use them both. At trick 2 play your small ♥ to the ♥Q. Play the ♣J, letting it ride when East plays low. Play a small ♣ to your ♣Q. Play the ♣A, dropping East's ♣K. And finally, play your ♥K to dummy's ♥A so you can enjoy cashing those two good ♣s.

Bridge is a nice game.

You sacrifice one sure ♥ winner to create a second dummy entry which creates two ♣ winners.

With 9 points you are in the game-invitational range. And with a 4-card ♥ suit you should use Stayman. You bid 2♣ and partner says 2♦. What is your next bid?

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You are still in game-invitational range, but now you invite partner with 2NT. He replies 3NT and that ends the bidding.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠10. You cross your fingers and put on dummy's ♠J. No good, East covers with the ♠Q and you are forced to take your